plement or totally replace fossil fuel energy for vehicle propulsion. Hybrid engines are smaller and more efficient than traditional fuel engines. Some hybrid vehicles use regenerative braking to generate electricity while travelling.

The first hybrid car invented was called the 'Mixte' and developed way back in 1902. It was invented by none other than Ferdinand Porsche founder of Porsche. The first commercial hybrid car was the Toyota Prius in 1997, made in Japan.

Hybrid cars produce 90% less pollution than other vehicles. The combustion engine itself generates electricity for the vehicle to charge so there is no need to 'stop and plug in' like electric cars. The depreciation of hybrids is also slower making them more cost effective. Repairs don't cost much and some governments even encourage the purchase of these environment friendly vehicles by offering tax rebates and other incentives. Performance wise Hybrids run at 50-60 miles per gallon, essentially using only a third of the fuel that a conventional vehicle would.

The invention of the Hybrid car has ensured that you can travel safely, at lower cost, with better mileage and a smaller carbon footprint.

Infrared

Who'd have thought of measuring the temperature of light. But that's how Sir William Herschel discovered infrared rays in 1800. Also known as thermal rays, they are beyond the visible range, below the red side of the spectrum (hence the name).

Probably the most common application of infrared rays is in the remote control, saving humanity the trouble of having to get up to flick channels on TV. They're also extensively used in mice, the ones connected to your PC, not the rodent variety. Its other applications are in the field of medicine, space and communication amongst several others. They are extensively used in night vision equipment to gauge distances, detect motion, and to increase